

Hegel — MCQ Solutions

Philosophy Optional — Paper I — Western Philosophy

Open only after attempting the corresponding question. Every solution explains all four options, identifies the examiner trap, gives a repair action, maps the coverage cell and links the relevant PYQ demand.

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MCQ 1

For Hegel, the dialectical method is best described as:

- A. a formal calculus that treats every contradiction as a defect in reasoning
- B. an externally imposed debate that alternates assertions with their simple denials
- C. an empirical pattern inferred from recurring stages in political and cultural history
- D. an immanent movement in which finite concepts expose, negate and overcome their own limits

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Formal consistency belongs to understanding, but Hegelian dialectic investigates contradictions generated within finite determinations. - **B:** Incorrect: This makes dialectic an external argumentative technique; Hegel presents the movement as arising from the content itself. - **C:** Incorrect: History exhibits dialectical movement, but the method is not an induction from historical sequences. - **D:** Correct: Dialectic is the self-movement of a determination through contradiction, determinate negation and a richer mediated form.

Examiner trap 1: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Dialectical method, logical moments and T-A-S caution.**

Repair action: Use abstract/negative/speculative moments and replace an external recipe with immanent development.

Coverage mapping: C02 — Dialectical method, logical moments and T-A-S caution.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 2

'Determinate negation' in Hegel means that:

- A. a definite concept's failure yields a specific successor that preserves its transformed content
- B. every denied concept dissolves into an empty nothing lacking any positive determination
- C. a thinker subjectively doubts a claim without exposing a defect within its content
- D. formal consistency requires excluding contradiction before any conceptual development can occur

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Determinate negation produces a contentful result constrained by the specific determination that fails. - **B:** Incorrect: This describes abstract negation; Hegel's negation preserves determinate content in the successor. - **C:** Incorrect: This reduces negation to a psychological act, whereas Hegel locates the tension within the concept. - **D:** Incorrect: This treats contradiction only as formal error and misses its role in transforming one-sided categories.

Examiner trap 2: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction:

Determinate negation, contradiction and mediation.

Repair action: State the precise defect, the constrained successor and why contradiction is not arbitrary inconsistency.

Coverage mapping: C03 — Determinate negation, contradiction and mediation.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 3

In Hegel's method, contradiction functions as:

- A. a terminal defect showing that the argument must return to its initial premise
- B. a verbal ambiguity removable by analysis without revising the conceptual content under examination
- C. an internal tension that drives a finite category toward a more adequate determination
- D. a projection of finite understanding onto a reality otherwise free from opposition

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel does not treat every contradiction as a terminal refutation; determinate contradiction can disclose the next category. - **B:** Incorrect: Some verbal confusions are removable, but dialectical contradiction concerns a category's substantive one-sidedness. - **C:** Correct: Contradiction is productive when an absolutised finite determination undermines itself and yields a constrained successor. - **D:** Incorrect: For Hegel opposition belongs to finite determinations themselves, not merely to a subject's mistaken projection.

Examiner trap 3: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction:

Determinate negation, contradiction and mediation.

Repair action: State the precise defect, the constrained successor and why contradiction is not arbitrary inconsistency.

Coverage mapping: C03 — Determinate negation, contradiction and mediation.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 4

Hegel's term *Aufhebung* (sublation) simultaneously means:

- A. cancelling a determination, preserving its truth, and raising it into a richer mediated unity
- B. rejecting a determination completely and replacing it with an unrelated category
- C. preserving a determination unchanged while adding a merely external qualification

D. raising a determination to a higher level without cancelling any of its limits

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Aufhebung combines cancellation, preservation and elevation within one determinate transition. - **B:** Incorrect: Complete replacement would be abstract negation and would lose the earlier determination's partial truth. - **C:** Incorrect: Unchanged preservation omits the negating moment through which the earlier form loses self-sufficiency. - **D:** Incorrect: Elevation without cancellation leaves the original limitation intact and therefore is not sublation.

Examiner trap 4: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction:
Aufhebung and Being–Nothing–Becoming.

Repair action: Recall cancel/preserve/raise and demonstrate the logical, non-temporal opening transition.

Coverage mapping: C04 — Aufhebung and Being–Nothing–Becoming.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 5

The opening triad of Hegel's Science of Logic runs:

- A. the Idea, external Nature, and self-returning Spirit
- B. a thesis, its antithesis, and their synthesis
- C. pure Being, pure Nothing, and their Becoming
- D. universality, particularity, and concrete individuality

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: This is the architecture of Hegel's system, not the opening transition within the Logic. - **B:** Incorrect: This is later shorthand rather than the actual opening categories of the Science of Logic. - **C:** Correct: Pure Being and pure Nothing prove indistinguishable in indeterminacy; their truth is Becoming. - **D:** Incorrect: These are moments of the Concept, reached much later than the opening doctrine of Being.

Examiner trap 5: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction:
Aufhebung and Being–Nothing–Becoming.

Repair action: Recall cancel/preserve/raise and demonstrate the logical, non-temporal opening transition.

Coverage mapping: C04 — Aufhebung and Being–Nothing–Becoming.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 6

Hegel's 'concrete universal' together with 'the True is the Whole' asserts that:

- A. truth consists in independent propositions whose meanings remain fixed outside any systematic relation or wider context
- B. truth belongs only to separate particulars because an articulated whole cannot be known
- C. truth is an abstract universal purified of every differentiating and particular content
- D. truth is a developed whole whose universal meaning is articulated through particular moments

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel denies that isolated propositions are fully self-standing; their truth depends on systematic mediation. - **B:** Incorrect: This reverses Hegel's claim that the whole is knowable through the development of its moments. - **C:** Incorrect: An empty universal excludes the differences required for Hegel's concrete, self-articulating universal. - **D:** Correct: The whole is concrete because it preserves and organises its differentiated moments rather than erasing them.

Examiner trap 6: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.**

Repair action: Contrast abstract universality and bad infinity with organised difference and self-return.

Coverage mapping: C05 — Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 7

In Hegel's system, Logic, Nature and Spirit correspond respectively to the Idea:

- A. Idea in itself, Idea outside itself, and Idea returned to itself
- B. Idea outside itself, Idea returned to itself, and Idea in itself, respectively
- C. Idea returned to itself, Idea in itself, and Idea outside itself
- D. Idea in itself, Idea returned to itself, and Idea outside itself

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Logic studies the Idea in itself, Nature its externality, and Spirit its return to self-knowledge. - **B:** Incorrect: This wrongly begins with Nature and ends with Logic, reversing the system's stated order. - **C:** Incorrect: This places Spirit first and Nature last, confusing self-return with self-externalisation. - **D:** Incorrect: This exchanges Nature and Spirit: externality precedes the Idea's return to itself.

Examiner trap 7: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **System architecture and phenomenological ladder.**

Repair action: Keep Logic–Nature–Spirit, Spirit's divisions and the Phenomenology's itinerary distinct.

Coverage mapping: C06 — System architecture and phenomenological ladder.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 8

Which sequence correctly orders the divisions of Hegel's philosophy of Spirit?

- A. Absolute Spirit, Objective Spirit, and Subjective Spirit, in descending order
- B. Objective Spirit, Subjective Spirit, and Absolute Spirit
- C. Subjective Spirit, Absolute Spirit, and Objective Spirit
- D. Subjective Spirit, Objective Spirit, and Absolute Spirit

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: This reverses the movement from individual mind through institutions to absolute self-knowledge. - **B:** Incorrect: Objective institutions do not precede the subjective capacities whose freedom they embody. - **C:** Incorrect: Absolute Spirit is the culmination, not an intermediate stage before Objective Spirit. - **D:** Correct: Spirit develops from individual mind, through social institutions, to art, religion and philosophy.

Examiner trap 8: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **System architecture and phenomenological ladder.**

Repair action: Keep Logic–Nature–Spirit, Spirit's divisions and the Phenomenology's itinerary distinct.

Coverage mapping: C06 — System architecture and phenomenological ladder.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 9

In Absolute Spirit, the three forms in which Spirit knows itself are:

- A. logical categories, natural forms, and historical institutions considered as system-wide domains
- B. family relations, civil society, and the constitutional state
- C. artistic intuition, religious representation, and philosophical thought
- D. sensation, perception, and the understanding of appearances

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: These span Logic, Nature and Objective Spirit rather than the internal forms of Absolute Spirit. - **B:** Incorrect: Family, civil society and state belong to Ethical Life within Objective Spirit. - **C:** Correct: Absolute Spirit knows itself sensuously in art, representationally in religion and conceptually in philosophy. - **D:** Incorrect: These are cognitive shapes associated with consciousness, not the three forms of Absolute Spirit.

Examiner trap 9: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **System architecture and phenomenological ladder.**

Repair action: Keep Logic–Nature–Spirit, Spirit's divisions and the Phenomenology's itinerary distinct.

Coverage mapping: C06 — System architecture and phenomenological ladder.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 10

The lordship-bondage dialectic begins from a struggle in which each self-consciousness seeks:

- A. secure possession of material goods supplied by the opposing consciousness
- B. complete isolation from every dependence upon another self-conscious being
- C. the opportunity to discipline the other through productive labour and service
- D. recognition of itself as an independent self-consciousness by the other

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Material acquisition is not the constitutive aim of the life-and-death struggle. - **B:** Incorrect: Self-consciousness requires recognition and therefore cannot establish itself through pure isolation. - **C:** Incorrect: Labour becomes important after domination is established; it is not the struggle's initial aim. - **D:** Correct: Each self seeks acknowledgement from another consciousness capable of conferring meaningful recognition.

Examiner trap 10: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Recognition and lordship–bondage.**

Repair action: Reconstruct struggle, failed recognition, fear, service, labour and the bounded reversal.

Coverage mapping: C07 — Recognition and lordship–bondage.

PYQ linkage: Support for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 11

In the master-slave dialectic, the bondsman advances toward independent self-consciousness through:

- A. fear of death and formative labour that gives enduring form to the worked object
- B. the lord's voluntary recognition of the bondsman as already fully independent
- C. victory over the lord in a renewed struggle that simply reverses their positions
- D. withdrawal from practical activity into the purely inward freedom of Stoicism

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Fear loosens attachment to fixed identity, while disciplined labour objectifies and educates the bondsman's powers. - **B:** Incorrect: The lord withholds reciprocal recognition; the bondsman's development does not arise from the lord's generosity. - **C:** Incorrect: Hegel's reversal is developmental, not a second combat that merely exchanges social roles. - **D:** Incorrect: Stoic inwardness follows the episode but is not the mechanism of the bondsman's formative advance.

Examiner trap 11: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction:
Recognition and lordship–bondage.

Repair action: Reconstruct struggle, failed recognition, fear, service, labour and the bounded reversal.

Coverage mapping: C07 — Recognition and lordship–bondage.

PYQ linkage: Support for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 12

The 'reversal' in the master-slave dialectic is that:

- A. the bondsman becomes wholly dependent because labour removes every form of self-relation
- B. the lord depends on labour and receives recognition from a consciousness he devalues
- C. both consciousnesses immediately achieve equal recognition once the struggle has ended
- D. the lord secures satisfying independence because consumption frees him from the object

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Labour develops the bondsman's durable relation to self and object rather than eliminating self-relation. - **B:** Correct: The lord's dependence on the bondsman's work and deficient recognition destabilises apparent mastery. - **C:** Incorrect: Reciprocal equality is not achieved within the episode; unequal recognition remains unresolved. - **D:** Incorrect: Consumption is fleeting and mediated by the bondsman's labour, so it does not secure independence.

Examiner trap 12: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction:
Recognition and lordship–bondage.

Repair action: Reconstruct struggle, failed recognition, fear, service, labour and the bounded reversal.

Coverage mapping: C07 — Recognition and lordship–bondage.

PYQ linkage: Support for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 13

In the Phenomenology, Stoicism is the freedom of self-consciousness that:

- A. retreats into universal thought and claims freedom whether enthroned or enchained
- B. denies all external reality and treats every object as a private mental construction

- C. projects an unchangeable divine essence beyond an abject and divided finite self
- D. achieves reconciliation by submitting desire and work to a mediating religious authority

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Stoicism locates freedom in the universality of thought independently of external social status. - **B:** Incorrect: This resembles a crude subjective idealism, not Stoic freedom within the Phenomenology. - **C:** Incorrect: Projection of the Unchangeable belongs to the later Unhappy Consciousness. - **D:** Incorrect: Mediated devotion and work occur within the Unhappy Consciousness, not Stoicism.

Examiner trap 13: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.**

Repair action: Trace the immanent failures through devotion, work, mediator and transition to Reason.

Coverage mapping: C08 — Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link: 2023 Q1(d), Existentialism-owned.

MCQ 14

Scepticism, as the truth of Stoicism, is characterised by Hegel as:

- A. active negation of determinate claims that contradicts its own continuing assertions
- B. serene indifference to fortune grounded in the universality of inward thought
- C. formative labour through which the dependent consciousness reshapes the objective world
- D. devotion to an Unchangeable beyond mediated by work, sacrifice, and religious authority

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Scepticism enacts universal negation yet continues to assert and act, producing a lived self-contradiction. - **B:** Incorrect: This describes Stoicism's abstract inward freedom rather than Scepticism's active negation. - **C:** Incorrect: This belongs to the bondsman's formation in the lordship-bondage episode. - **D:** Incorrect: This describes the religiously divided Unhappy Consciousness that follows Scepticism.

Examiner trap 14: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.**

Repair action: Trace the immanent failures through devotion, work, mediator and transition to Reason.

Coverage mapping: C08 — Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link: 2023 Q1(d), Existentialism-owned.

MCQ 15

The Unhappy Consciousness is Hegel's analysis of:

- A. an ethical community whose shared institutions reconcile individual and universal freedom
- B. a lord whose consumption has secured complete independence from dependent recognition
- C. a sceptic whose universal negation has become coherent and free of self-contradiction
- D. a divided self that places the Unchangeable beyond itself and devalues its own finite agency

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Reconciled ethical life belongs to Objective Spirit, whereas the Unhappy Consciousness remains divided. - **B:** Incorrect: The lord's dependence is exposed rather than resolved, and this is not the religious division at issue. - **C:** Incorrect: Scepticism's contradiction leads into unhappiness; it does not become a stable reconciled standpoint. - **D:** Correct: The Unhappy Consciousness experiences its finite self as nothing beside an alien, unchangeable universal.

Examiner trap 15: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.**

Repair action: Trace the immanent failures through devotion, work, mediator and transition to Reason.

Coverage mapping: C08 — Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link: 2023 Q1(d), Existentialism-owned.

MCQ 16

Hegel's dictum 'What is rational is actual and what is actual is rational' is correctly read as:

- A. every long-standing institution is rational merely because it persists and exercises an established social function
- B. no existing political or social order can be criticised by standards of reason
- C. actuality names existence that realises its concept, unlike merely present existence
- D. only conceptual structures are real, whereas events and institutions are appearances

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Longevity establishes persistence, not Wirklichkeit as realised rational essence. - **B:** Incorrect: The distinction between existence and actuality enables immanent criticism of defective institutions. - **C:** Correct: Wirklichkeit is conceptually adequate existence; Dasein may persist while failing its own rational norm. - **D:** Incorrect: Hegel does not deny events and institutions reality; he assesses their degree of conceptual adequacy.

Examiner trap 16: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.**

Repair action: Distinguish moment from illusion, Wirklichkeit from Dasein, and active subject from inert substance.

Coverage mapping: C09 — Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(d); 2021 Q2(a); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 17

In insisting the Absolute is 'Subject, not merely Substance', Hegel chiefly corrects:

- A. Spinozist substance lacking self-mediation, development, and return through conscious Spirit itself
- B. Kantian causality limited to appearances as a correction to an inert metaphysics of substance
- C. Berkeleyan ideas ordered by God and perceived within finite immaterial spirits
- D. Fichtean opposition between the self-positing ego and a limiting non-ego within consciousness

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Hegel transforms inert substance into a self-differentiating subject that returns to itself in knowledge. - **B:** Incorrect: Causality is relevant to Kant, but 'Subject, not merely Substance' directly targets a substance metaphysics. - **C:** Incorrect: Berkeley is a comparison for idealism, not the principal target of this formulation. - **D:** Incorrect: Fichte influences post-Kantian development, but the explicit contrast here is with substance, especially Spinoza.

Examiner trap 17: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.**

Repair action: Distinguish moment from illusion, Wirklichkeit from Dasein, and active subject from inert substance.

Coverage mapping: C09 — Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(d); 2021 Q2(a); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 18

Within Hegel's Absolute Idealism, the phenomenal world is:

- A. a finite but real moment through which the self-developing Absolute manifests itself
- B. an independent thing-in-itself that remains permanently external to rational mediation
- C. a collection of private ideas contained separately within each empirical human mind
- D. an entirely unreal veil that must disappear without preservation in Absolute knowledge

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Phenomenal reality is preserved as the Absolute's finite self-manifestation, though not as self-subsistent. - **B:** Incorrect: A permanently external thing-in-itself is precisely the Kantian remainder Hegel challenges. - **C:** Incorrect: This reduces Absolute Idealism to a crude subjective idealism of private representations. - **D:** Incorrect: Sublation preserves finite truth; it does not simply abolish the phenomenal world as unreal.

Examiner trap 18: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.**

Repair action: Distinguish moment from illusion, Wirklichkeit from Dasein, and active subject from inert substance.

Coverage mapping: C09 — Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(d); 2021 Q2(a); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 19

Hegel's core objection to Kant's unknowable thing-in-itself is that:

- A. ordinary perception directly reveals noumenal objects as they are in themselves once conceptual mediation is suspended
- B. a determinately asserted limit is already thought relationally and cannot remain wholly external
- C. the moral law supplies theoretical knowledge of the thing-in-itself as a positive object
- D. noumenal things are identical with Berkeleyan ideas perceived and coordinated by God

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel does not bypass concepts through unmediated perception of noumena. - **B:** Correct: Thinking a determinate boundary relates its sides and destabilises a positively characterised unknowable beyond. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant's practical postulates do not amount to theoretical cognition of noumenal objects. - **D:** Incorrect: Berkeley's ontology of ideas and spirits is not Kant's distinction between appearances and things in themselves.

Examiner trap 19: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Hegel's challenge to Kant.**

Repair action: Give the relational-limit critique, Kant's negative-noumenon reply and a bounded verdict.

Coverage mapping: C10 — Hegel's challenge to Kant.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q1(e); 2026 Q4(b) cross-link.

MCQ 20

Strawson's The Bounds of Sense converges with Hegel in holding that:

- A. pure reason can positively describe supersensible objects without conditions supplied by sensibility or understanding
- B. critical philosophy should be enlarged into a complete metaphysics of the self-knowing Absolute
- C. a supersensible cause of sensibility misuses concepts whose legitimate use is restricted to experience
- D. space and time belong to things in themselves rather than to our forms of sensible intuition

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Strawson rejects positive supersensible knowledge instead of licensing it. - **B:** Incorrect: Unlike Hegel, Strawson reconstructs a descriptive conceptual scheme rather than Absolute Idealism. - **C:** Correct: Strawson's criticism converges with Hegel against using existence and causation beyond their warranted domain. - **D:** Incorrect: Strawson does not convert Kantian forms of intuition into properties of noumenal objects.

Examiner trap 20: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Hegel's challenge to Kant.**

Repair action: Give the relational-limit critique, Kant's negative-noumenon reply and a bounded verdict.

Coverage mapping: C10 — Hegel's challenge to Kant.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q1(e); 2026 Q4(b) cross-link.

MCQ 21

The Logic-to-Nature transition - the Idea 'freely releasing itself' - is best understood as:

- A. a divine act of creation that occurs at the first moment of cosmic time
- B. a non-temporal claim that pure self-relating form determines itself as externality
- C. an efficient causal process in which logical categories physically produce matter
- D. an a priori derivation of each empirical species, planet, and contingent natural fact

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The transition belongs to systematic logic and is not a dated cosmological event. - **B:** Correct: Free release is read as the Idea's logical self-externalisation, not temporal or efficient causation. - **C:** Incorrect: Categories do not function as physical causes operating before Nature exists. - **D:** Incorrect: Hegel's account of Nature allows contingency and does not deduce every empirical particular.

Examiner trap 21: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency**.

Repair action: Explain free release non-temporally, impotence of nature, objections and residual existence gap.

Coverage mapping: C11 — Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.

PYQ linkage: Refinement for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 22

Hegel's phrase 'the impotence of nature' (Ohnmacht der Natur) means that:

- A. Nature achieves a more adequate rational form than Spirit because externality perfects the Concept
- B. Nature fails to embody the Concept perfectly and therefore displays contingency and irregularity
- C. Nature lacks any reality because only logical categories possess genuine philosophical being
- D. Natural science is impossible because empirical observation cannot disclose rational structures

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Spirit is the return from natural externality to self-conscious conceptual form, not a decline from Nature. - **B:** Correct: The phrase marks Nature's inability to hold the Concept with the exactness found in Logic. - **C:** Incorrect: Nature is real as the Idea in otherness even though it contains contingency. - **D:** Incorrect: Hegel uses empirical science while denying that philosophy can deduce every contingent detail.

Examiner trap 22: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency**.

Repair action: Explain free release non-temporally, impotence of nature, objections and residual existence gap.

Coverage mapping: C11 — Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.

PYQ linkage: Refinement for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 23

The strongest objection to the Logic-to-Nature transition, launching later existentialism, was pressed by:

- A. Trendelenburg, who argues that dialectic imports motion into otherwise static categories
- B. Feuerbach, who interprets the transition as creation theology translated into concepts
- C. Schelling, who argues that logical essence cannot generate the sheer fact of existence itself
- D. Popper, who attacks retrospective historical necessity as resistant to falsification

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Trendelenburg's motion objection is important, but it is not the existence objection linked to later existentialism. - **B:** Incorrect: Feuerbach exposes a theological residue, but the essence-to-existence challenge is Schelling's. - **C:** Correct: Schelling's demand for the 'that' of existence directly contests deduction from conceptual essence. - **D:** Incorrect: Popper's principal target is historicist explanation, not the specific category-to-existence transition.

Examiner trap 23: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.**

Repair action: Explain free release non-temporally, impotence of nature, objections and residual existence gap.

Coverage mapping: C11 — Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.

PYQ linkage: Refinement for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 24

Hegel's three great stages in the history of freedom run:

- A. all persons free, then some citizens free, then one ruler alone free
- B. some citizens free, then one ruler alone free, then all persons free
- C. one ruler alone free, then all persons free, then some citizens free in Hegel's claimed progression
- D. one ruler alone free, then some citizens free, then all persons free

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: This reverses Hegel's retrospective progression by beginning with universal freedom. - **B:** Incorrect: This moves backward from partial freedom to despotism before recovering universality. - **C:** Incorrect: This places universal freedom before the classical restriction to some citizens. - **D:** Correct: Hegel's schematic sequence moves from despotism, through limited citizenship, to universal freedom in principle.

Examiner trap 24: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.**

Repair action: Link institutions and historical tensions to freedom while criticising teleology and Eurocentrism.

Coverage mapping: C12 — Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q1(b).

MCQ 25

The 'cunning of reason' (List der Vernunft) names Hegel's idea that:

- A. world-historical individuals consciously design every stage of the rational historical process
- B. reason employs private passions as instruments for ends the agents do not themselves intend
- C. historical events arise randomly and acquire rational significance only through later narration
- D. reason deceives itself through human action and therefore never attains institutional expression

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Agents such as Caesar or Napoleon pursue situated aims rather than possessing the whole rational plan. - **B:** Correct: The cunning of reason works through passions whose broader historical consequences exceed agents' intentions. - **C:** Incorrect: Hegel's claim is stronger than retrospective storytelling: history has an intelligible development of freedom. - **D:** Incorrect: Reason is realised through institutions despite conflict; it is not permanently defeated by agency.

Examiner trap 25: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.**

Repair action: Link institutions and historical tensions to freedom while criticising teleology and Eurocentrism.

Coverage mapping: C12 — Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q1(b).

MCQ 26

Popper's criticism is most sharply aimed at Hegel's:

- A. retrospective philosophy of history that can redescribe events as necessary after they occur
- B. the Science of Logic considered solely as an invalid symbolic calculus rather than a philosophy of historical prediction
- C. the lordship-bondage episode treated as a testable prediction of immediate emancipation
- D. the three senses of Aufhebung treated as a contradiction in ordinary lexical usage

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Popper principally attacks historicism and claims of necessity that evade risky prediction or falsification. - **B:** Incorrect: Hegel's Logic is not offered as a symbolic calculus, so this misidentifies Popper's main charge. - **C:** Incorrect: The episode is not an empirical timetable, and Popper's central criticism is broader philosophy of history. - **D:** Incorrect: The semantic range of Aufhebung is not the target of Popper's political and methodological critique.

Examiner trap 26: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.**

Repair action: Link institutions and historical tensions to freedom while criticising teleology and Eurocentrism.

Coverage mapping: C12 — Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q1(b).

MCQ 27

The decisive contrast between Berkeley's subjective idealism and Hegel's absolute idealism is that:

- A. Berkeley treats experienced objects as ideas ordered by divine perception, while Hegel makes the Absolute a timeless perceiver of those ideas
- B. both make reality a collection of ideas privately possessed by finite spirits and coordinated by one transcendent divine mind
- C. Hegel explains ideas through God's infinite perception, while Berkeley makes nature and finite spirit moments of a dialectical whole
- D. Berkeley: ideas perceived by finite spirits and ordered in God's infinite perception; Hegel: nature and finite spirit are moments of the Absolute

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Berkeley's divine perception secures the continuity of ideas, but Hegel's Absolute is self-developing Spirit, not a timeless perceiver of Berkeleyan contents. - **B:** Incorrect: Berkeley includes finite spirits and God, while Hegel rejects reduction to private mental contents. - **C:** Incorrect: Divine ordering and continuous infinite perception belong to Berkeley, not Hegel; Nature is Hegel's Idea in otherness. - **D:** Correct: This states Berkeley's ideas, finite spirits and divine coordination while distinguishing Hegel's encompassing Absolute.

Examiner trap 27: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Comparisons with Berkeley, Spinoza, Kierkegaard and Marx.**

Repair action: Fix the comparison axis and state what each thinker retains, rejects or transforms.

Coverage mapping: C13 — Comparisons with Berkeley, Spinoza, Kierkegaard and Marx.

PYQ linkage: Cross-links: 2018 Q2(b), 2023 Q1(d), 2024 Q2(a), 2026 Q4(b).

MCQ 28

Marx's relation to Hegel is most accurately summarised as:

- A. retaining dialectical transformation while relocating it from the Idea to material social relations

- B. rejecting dialectical development together with every material explanation of contradiction, labour, and historical conflict
- C. accepting Hegel's idealist system while replacing only his terminology of contradiction
- D. retaining the self-developing Idea while abandoning contradiction, labour, and historical change

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Marx transforms rather than discards dialectic, grounding it in material production and social contradiction. - **B:** Incorrect: Marx's historical materialism relies on conflict and development rather than rejecting both. - **C:** Incorrect: Marx famously criticises and inverts Hegel's idealism instead of accepting the system unchanged. - **D:** Incorrect: This preserves precisely the idealist priority Marx rejects and removes the dialectical mechanism he retains.

Examiner trap 28: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Comparisons with Berkeley, Spinoza, Kierkegaard and Marx.**

Repair action: Fix the comparison axis and state what each thinker retains, rejects or transforms.

Coverage mapping: C13 — Comparisons with Berkeley, Spinoza, Kierkegaard and Marx.

PYQ linkage: Cross-links: 2018 Q2(b), 2023 Q1(d), 2024 Q2(a), 2026 Q4(b).

MCQ 29

Which statement about 'thesis-antithesis-synthesis' is correct?

- A. Hegel coined the exact formula and used it as the universal algorithm of the Logic
- B. the formula is a later shorthand associated with Fichte and Chalybaeus, not Hegel's regular schema
- C. Kant introduced the exact formula for the antinomies and Hegel adopted it without alteration
- D. the formula is a recent editorial error with no identifiable place in nineteenth-century reception

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel rarely uses the three-word formula and does not present it as a universal algorithm. - **B:** Correct: The safe provenance note links the shorthand to Fichtean structure and Chalybaeus's popularisation. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant's antinomies influenced dialectic, but he did not supply this exact formula for Hegel to copy. - **D:** Incorrect: The label has a traceable nineteenth-century history and is not merely a modern misprint.

Examiner trap 29: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Sources, registers, quotation and scope discipline.**

Repair action: Distinguish logical, phenomenological and historical registers; use safe quotations and owner boundaries.

Coverage mapping: C15 — Sources, registers, quotation and scope discipline.

PYQ linkage: All answers; prevents provenance and scope errors.

MCQ 30

The claim that 'Hegel tried to deduce the number of planets a priori' is:

- A. an accurate summary of how the Philosophy of Nature derives every astronomical detail
- B. evidence that Hegel regarded all contingent observations as deductions from pure categories
- C. a direct consequence of free release understood as an empirical theory of planetary formation
- D. a caricature, since nature's contingency blocks a priori deduction of every particular fact

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel's speculative treatment of Nature does not amount to deriving every astronomical particular. - **B:** Incorrect: The 'impotence of nature' explicitly allows contingency that cannot be read straight from Logic. - **C:** Incorrect: Free release is a logical transition, not an empirical cosmogony predicting planetary formation. - **D:** Correct: The caricature ignores Hegel's own insistence that Nature imperfectly embodies the Concept.

Examiner trap 30: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.**

Repair action: Explain free release non-temporally, impotence of nature, objections and residual existence gap.

Coverage mapping: C11 — Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.

PYQ linkage: Refinement for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 31

Regarding Popper's 'unfalsifiability' charge, the disciplined view is that it:

- A. decisively refutes every transition in the Science of Logic as an empirical prediction
- B. targets retrospective historicism strongly but fits the categorial Logic only with qualification
- C. applies equally to Hegel's logical, natural, historical, political, and cultural claims without any qualification
- D. repeats a methodological criticism that Hegel explicitly formulated and accepted himself

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The Logic articulates categories rather than issuing ordinary empirical predictions to be falsified. - **B:** Correct: Popper's charge is strongest against historical necessity and weaker when transferred unchanged to categorial analysis. - **C:** Incorrect: The different registers make

a uniform falsifiability verdict philosophically indiscriminate. - **D:** Incorrect: Popper is a later critic; Hegel did not endorse Popper's account of unfalsifiable historicism.

Examiner trap 31: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Criticisms and replies.**

Repair action: Attribute Trendelenburg, Schelling, Kierkegaard, Marx and Popper accurately and state the best reply/residual.

Coverage mapping: C14 — Criticisms and replies.

PYQ linkage: Evaluation across 2021, 2022, 2023 and 2025.

MCQ 32

What is the controlled point of Being–Nothing–Becoming?

- A. Nothing is a concealed physical entity encountered after the disappearance of ordinary beings
- B. pure Being and pure Nothing coincide in indeterminacy, while Becoming expresses their passage
- C. Being first exists in time and then causally produces Nothing as a second event
- D. the opening mnemonic mechanically guarantees every later category and transition without any additional immanent argument

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Nothing is a logical category of indeterminacy, not an occult object. - **B:** Correct: The transition turns on the indistinguishability of empty Being and empty Nothing and their unity in Becoming. - **C:** Incorrect: The sequence is logical rather than a chronology in which one event produces another. - **D:** Incorrect: The opening illustrates the method but cannot substitute for arguments supporting later transitions.

Examiner trap 32: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Aufhebung and Being–Nothing–Becoming.**

Repair action: Recall cancel/preserve/raise and demonstrate the logical, non-temporal opening transition.

Coverage mapping: C04 — Aufhebung and Being–Nothing–Becoming.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 33

Which sequence gives the moments of the Concept (*Begriff*)?

- A. Logic, Nature, and Spirit as the main divisions of Hegel's system
- B. artistic intuition, religious representation, and philosophical comprehension

- C. universality, particularity, and individuality within one self-determining Concept
- D. an initial thesis, an opposed antithesis, and an externally composed synthesis

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: These describe the system's three domains, not the internal moments of the Begriff. - **B:** Incorrect: These are forms of Absolute Spirit rather than universality, particularity and individuality. - **C:** Correct: The Concept particularises its universality and returns as concrete individuality. - **D:** Incorrect: This later shorthand suggests an external recipe and does not name the Concept's moments.

Examiner trap 33: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.**

Repair action: Contrast abstract universality and bad infinity with organised difference and self-return.

Coverage mapping: C05 — Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 34

Which verdict on Hegel's challenge to Kant is most precise?

- A. it pressures reified two-world readings, while Kant's negative-noumenon reply remains available
- B. thinking any conceptual boundary immediately proves every substantive proposition and transition claimed within Absolute Idealism
- C. Kant positively describes noumenal objects through the categories of cause and existence
- D. Hegel preserves a permanently external unknowable remainder alongside mediated experience

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Hegel's relational-limit argument is strongest against a positive external remainder but does not silence every Kantian reply. - **B:** Incorrect: Crossing a conceptual limit does not by itself establish all transitions or contents of Absolute Idealism. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant denies theoretical knowledge of noumena; positive description is the very problem under dispute. - **D:** Incorrect: Hegel's project seeks to overcome, not preserve, a permanently external thing-in-itself.

Examiner trap 34: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Hegel's challenge to Kant.**

Repair action: Give the relational-limit critique, Kant's negative-noumenon reply and a bounded verdict.

Coverage mapping: C10 — Hegel's challenge to Kant.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q1(e); 2026 Q4(b) cross-link.

MCQ 35

What is Hegel's true infinite?

- A. an endless advance from one finite term to another finite term beyond it
- B. a supernatural entity separated from finite existence by an unbridgeable boundary
- C. a mediated self-relation that includes finite limitation and returns from otherness into itself
- D. the elimination of finite beings as wholly unreal appearances without determinate content

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Endless progression is the bad infinite because it remains dependent on the finite it excludes. - **B:** Incorrect: A separate beyond repeats the bad infinite's opposition between finite and infinite. - **C:** Correct: True infinity contains its finite moment and achieves self-return rather than fleeing endlessly beyond it. - **D:** Incorrect: Finite determinations are preserved as moments; Hegel does not make them sheer nothing.

Examiner trap 35: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.**

Repair action: Contrast abstract universality and bad infinity with organised difference and self-return.

Coverage mapping: C05 — Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 36

How should Hegel's one–some–all history scheme be used?

- A. as a neutral contemporary taxonomy for comparing every civilisation without normative ranking, exclusion, or Eurocentric hierarchy
- B. as proof that each historical event necessarily increases freedom in an observable sequence
- C. as a substitute for explaining determinate negation and sublation in Hegel's logical method
- D. as Hegel's retrospective Eurocentric teleology, followed by criticism of exclusion and determinism

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The scheme ranks civilisations from Hegel's contested European standpoint and is not neutral. - **B:** Incorrect: Hegel's broad direction does not entail that every event is progressive or empirically predictable. - **C:** Incorrect: A historical schema may illustrate dialectic but cannot replace an account of the logical mechanism. - **D:** Correct: A disciplined answer states Hegel's progression and then evaluates its Eurocentrism and retrospective necessity.

Examiner trap 36: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.**

Repair action: Link institutions and historical tensions to freedom while criticising teleology and Eurocentrism.

Coverage mapping: C12 — Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q1(b).

MCQ 37

Which belongs outside the printed Hegel owner except as bounded orientation?

- A. full political philosophy, aesthetics, religion, and later Marxist or analytic receptions
- B. the doctrine of Absolute Idealism and reality as a self-developing rational whole within the printed syllabus owner
- C. the 2025 challenge to Kant's distinction between phenomena and noumena
- D. determinate negation, contradiction, mediation, and the structure of sublation

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: These materials are useful bounded orientations but extend beyond the printed Hegel owner. - **B:** Incorrect: Absolute Idealism is explicitly within the Hegel syllabus owner and cannot be excluded. - **C:** Incorrect: The Kant challenge is a directly owned Hegel PYQ from 2025. - **D:** Incorrect: These concepts form the core of the directly printed dialectical-method owner.

Examiner trap 37: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Sources, registers, quotation and scope discipline.**

Repair action: Distinguish logical, phenomenological and historical registers; use safe quotations and owner boundaries.

Coverage mapping: C15 — Sources, registers, quotation and scope discipline.

PYQ linkage: All answers; prevents provenance and scope errors.

MCQ 38

Consider the following statements about Hegel's post-Kantian project.

1. Hegel accepts Kant's claim that objectivity requires conceptual form.
2. Hegel treats phenomenon/noumenon and subject/object as permanently external limits.
3. Hegel tests fixed oppositions by asking whether each can be intelligible without its excluded other.
4. Hegelian reconciliation means erasing every difference between the opposed terms.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. statements 2 and 4 only
- B. statements 1, 2 and 3 only
- C. statements 1 and 3 only
- D. statements 1, 3 and 4 only

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Statements 2 and 4 both freeze or erase differences that Hegel instead seeks to mediate. - **B:** Incorrect: Statement 2 is false because Hegel challenges permanently external subject-object and phenomenon-noumenon limits. - **C:** Correct: Hegel retains Kant's constitutive insight and tests fixed oppositions immanently, so statements 1 and 3 are correct. - **D:** Incorrect: Statement 4 is false because reconciliation preserves determinate difference rather than erasing it.

Examiner trap 38: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Kant's residual dualisms and Hegel's immanent project.**

Repair action: Reconstruct Kant's achievement and the fixed oppositions Hegel attempts to mediate.

Coverage mapping: C01 — Kant's residual dualisms and Hegel's immanent project.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q1(e); 2026 Q4(b) cross-link.

MCQ 39

A candidate claims that Hegelian contradiction licenses accepting any proposition whatever. Which response is most defensible?

- A. agree, because Hegel abandons every constraint on valid inference and conceptual succession
- B. disagree, because contradiction never appears within Hegel's account of finite categories
- C. agree, because Becoming temporally alternates between any true proposition and its negation
- D. disagree, because finite self-opposition must generate a constrained determinate successor

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel does not license arbitrary inference; the successor is constrained by the determination's specific defect. - **B:** Incorrect: Contradiction is central to dialectical development, so denying its presence evades the issue. - **C:** Incorrect: Being-Nothing-Becoming is a logical transition, not temporal oscillation between arbitrary propositions. - **D:** Correct: Determinate contradiction differs from unrestricted formal inconsistency and does not entail logical explosion.

Examiner trap 39: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Determinate negation, contradiction and mediation.**

Repair action: State the precise defect, the constrained successor and why contradiction is not arbitrary inconsistency.

Coverage mapping: C03 — Determinate negation, contradiction and mediation.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 40

Which inference best expresses Hegelian mediation?

- A. related terms are genuine only after each is completely defined in isolation from the other
- B. a term can truly depend on its excluded other for identity without becoming identical with it
- C. relational dependence proves that all differences between the related terms are merely unreal
- D. mediation requires an external observer to combine two otherwise complete and finished terms

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel challenges the abstraction of self-sufficient terms whose identities precede every relation. - **B:** Correct: Identity-in-difference makes relation constitutive while preserving determinate distinction. - **C:** Incorrect: Mediation preserves differentiated terms and therefore does not collapse them into featureless unity. - **D:** Incorrect: Hegelian mediation is immanent to the terms rather than supplied by a third-party observer.

Examiner trap 40: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.**

Repair action: Contrast abstract universality and bad infinity with organised difference and self-return.

Coverage mapping: C05 — Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 41

A finite limit is repeatedly crossed only to reveal another limit beyond it. For Hegel this most directly exemplifies

- A. bad infinity, because each crossed finite boundary merely produces another external beyond
- B. Absolute Spirit, because endless quantitative progression completes philosophical self-knowledge
- C. negative noumenon, because each new limit marks an unknowable object outside experience
- D. concrete universality, because an indefinite series organises all differences within one whole

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: The endless ought-to-be beyond remains dependent on the finite boundary and never returns to itself. - **B:** Incorrect: Absolute Spirit is qualitative self-comprehension, not an indefinitely extended sequence. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant's negative noumenon limits cognition; it is not

Hegel's diagnosis of endless progression. - **D:** Incorrect: A concrete universal internally organises its moments instead of adding one external term after another.

Examiner trap 41: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.**

Repair action: Contrast abstract universality and bad infinity with organised difference and self-return.

Coverage mapping: C05 — Concrete universal, identity-in-difference, Concept and true infinite.

PYQ linkage: 2019 Q1(c); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 42

In the *Phenomenology of Spirit*, a "shape of consciousness" is overcome when

1. its object fails the shape's own criterion;
2. only the object changes while the standard remains untouched;
3. both the account of the object and the knowing standpoint are transformed;
4. an external philosopher imposes a criterion unrelated to the shape.

Which are correct?

- A. statements 1 and 3 only
- B. statements 1 and 2 only
- C. statements 2 and 4 only
- D. statements 1, 3 and 4 only

Answer: A.

Option explanations: - **A:** Correct: Experience exposes failure by the shape's own criterion and transforms both object and knowing standpoint. - **B:** Incorrect: Statement 2 is false because the criterion changes with the shape's account of its object. - **C:** Incorrect: Both statements replace immanent development with an unchanged standard or an external imposition. - **D:** Incorrect: Statement 4 is false because the philosopher does not impose an unrelated criterion from outside.

Examiner trap 42: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **System architecture and phenomenological ladder.**

Repair action: Keep Logic–Nature–Spirit, Spirit's divisions and the Phenomenology's itinerary distinct.

Coverage mapping: C06 — System architecture and phenomenological ladder.

PYQ linkage: 2021 Q2(a); 2022 Q3(b); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 43

Which conclusion goes beyond what Hegel's lordship–bondage episode by itself establishes?

- A. subordinate recognition cannot satisfy the lord's claim to independent self-certainty
- B. fear, service, and formative labour can transform the bondsman's practical self-relation
- C. every historical domination must quickly collapse into equal and reciprocal recognition
- D. unequal recognition is internally unstable as an account of self-conscious freedom

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: This is a bounded result of the lord's dependence on recognition from a devalued consciousness. - **B:** Incorrect: This is the episode's account of the bondsman's formative route through work and fear. - **C:** Correct: The episode supplies neither a timetable nor a guarantee for immediate historical emancipation. - **D:** Incorrect: This conceptual instability follows from recognition that is one-sided and therefore unsatisfying.

Examiner trap 43: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Recognition and lordship–bondage.**

Repair action: Reconstruct struggle, failed recognition, fear, service, labour and the bounded reversal.

Coverage mapping: C07 — Recognition and lordship–bondage.

PYQ linkage: Support for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 44

Why does complete self-renunciation reverse into a transition toward Reason in Hegel's account?

- A. the mediator confirms that the Unchangeable must remain permanently external to finite activity, work, and self-conscious agency
- B. self-renunciation reveals universality operating through the self's own activity rather than beyond it
- C. the self abandons disciplined work and returns to the abstract inward freedom of Stoicism
- D. religious devotion removes the contradiction of Scepticism while preserving its universal negation

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The movement undermines the alien beyond instead of confirming its permanent externality. - **B:** Correct: The self discovers its own activity within the universal it had projected elsewhere, enabling the transition to Reason. - **C:** Incorrect: The sequence advances beyond Stoicism and incorporates work rather than abandoning it. - **D:** Incorrect: Unhappy Consciousness makes division explicit; devotion alone does not render sceptical negation coherent.

Examiner trap 44: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.**

Repair action: Trace the immanent failures through devotion, work, mediator and transition to Reason.

Coverage mapping: C08 — Stoicism, Scepticism and Unhappy Consciousness.

PYQ linkage: Cross-link: 2023 Q1(d), Existentialism-owned.

MCQ 45

An institution exists for centuries but systematically defeats the freedom it officially claims to realise. Which Hegelian assessment is strongest?

- A. its long duration alone establishes that it has realised a rational and necessary essence
- B. it may merely exist while lacking actuality because its social practice contradicts its rational concept
- C. its continued existence proves that rational criticism of the institution is conceptually impossible
- D. it is unreal only if no subject can perceive its operations or experience their consequences

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Persistence is Dasein, not proof that the institution fulfils the concept constitutive of Wirklichkeit. - **B:** Correct: Immanent failure to realise its professed freedom can deprive an existent institution of full actuality. - **C:** Incorrect: The gap between concept and practice is precisely what makes rational criticism possible. - **D:** Incorrect: Perceptibility establishes empirical existence, not adequacy to a rational institutional concept.

Examiner trap 45: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.**

Repair action: Distinguish moment from illusion, Wirklichkeit from Dasein, and active subject from inert substance.

Coverage mapping: C09 — Absolute Idealism, phenomenal reality, substance-as-subject and actuality.

PYQ linkage: 2020 Q1(d); 2021 Q2(a); 2026 Q1(c).

MCQ 46

What follows most securely from Hegel's argument that a determinately thought limit is relational?

- A. crossing one conceptual limit proves every later claim of the Absolute system
- B. Kant failed to distinguish a negative limiting concept from a positively described noumenon
- C. all empirical distinctions between knowing subjects and encountered objects thereby disappear
- D. a positive unknowable remainder is unstable, though the complete system still needs further argument

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The limit argument challenges one boundary but does not prove all claims and transitions of the system. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant's negative-noumenon distinction is the strongest reply that a fair reconstruction must acknowledge. - **C:** Incorrect: Hegel seeks mediated identity-in-

difference, not the erasure of empirical subject-object distinctions. - **D:** Correct: This is the bounded conclusion: the critique pressures reified externality without independently proving totality.

Examiner trap 46: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Hegel's challenge to Kant.**

Repair action: Give the relational-limit critique, Kant's negative-noumenon reply and a bounded verdict.

Coverage mapping: C10 — Hegel's challenge to Kant.

PYQ linkage: 2025 Q1(e); 2026 Q4(b) cross-link.

MCQ 47

Match the critic to the objection.

1. Schelling — the Logic cannot generate the sheer fact that anything exists.
2. Trendelenburg — dialectical movement imports motion not derived from static categories.
3. Feuerbach — "free release" redescribes creation theology in conceptual language.
4. Popper — the category-to-existence transition is primarily a problem of retrospective historicism.

Which statements are correctly matched?

- A. statements 1 and 4 only
- B. statements 2 and 3 only
- C. all four statements: 1, 2, 3 and 4
- D. statements 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Statement 1 is correct, but statement 4 misplaces Popper's historicism critique at the Logic-Nature seam. - **B:** Incorrect: Statements 2 and 3 are correct, but Schelling's essence-to-existence objection must also be included. - **C:** Incorrect: Statement 4 is false because Popper's retrospective-historicism charge primarily targets philosophy of history. - **D:** Correct: Schelling, Trendelenburg and Feuerbach are correctly matched; Popper is not matched to this specific transition.

Examiner trap 47: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.**

Repair action: Explain free release non-temporally, impotence of nature, objections and residual existence gap.

Coverage mapping: C11 — Logic-to-Nature transition and contingency.

PYQ linkage: Refinement for 2021 Q2(a) and 2022 Q3(b).

MCQ 48

Which sequence and interpretation best fit Hegel's Objective Spirit?

- A. subjective mind, natural externality, and art; freedom means withdrawal from social relations
- B. right, morality, and ethical life; freedom becomes concrete in differentiated institutions
- C. family, religion, and philosophy; freedom remains private conviction opposed to institutions
- D. civil society, sense-certainty, and state; freedom means absence of determinate social norms

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: This mixes system divisions and reduces freedom to merely negative independence. - **B:** Correct: Objective Spirit develops through right, morality and ethical life embodied in family, civil society and state. - **C:** Incorrect: Religion and philosophy belong to Absolute Spirit, while Hegelian freedom requires institutional embodiment. - **D:** Incorrect: Sense-certainty belongs to the Phenomenology, and freedom is rational self-determination rather than normlessness.

Examiner trap 48: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.**

Repair action: Link institutions and historical tensions to freedom while criticising teleology and Eurocentrism.

Coverage mapping: C12 — Objective Spirit, history, freedom and cunning of reason.

PYQ linkage: 2023 Q1(b).

MCQ 49

Which set is accurately attributed?

1. Kierkegaard — the system loses the existing individual.
2. Marx — dialectic must be relocated in material and social relations.
3. Popper — retrospective historical necessity risks unfalsifiable historicism.
4. Trendelenburg — the main defect is that Hegel preserves too much finite individuality.

Select the correct answer.

- A. statements 1 and 2 only
- B. all four statements: 1, 2, 3 and 4
- C. statements 3 and 4 only
- D. statements 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: D.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Kierkegaard and Marx are correctly matched, but Popper's historicism criticism is also correct. - **B:** Incorrect: Statement 4 is false because Trendelenburg objects that dialectic imports motion into static categories. - **C:** Incorrect: Statement 4 is false, while this selection also omits the valid Kierkegaard and Marx attributions. - **D:** Correct: The first three attributions are accurate; Trendelenburg's actual objection concerns smuggled motion.

Examiner trap 49: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Criticisms and replies.**

Repair action: Attribute Trendelenburg, Schelling, Kierkegaard, Marx and Popper accurately and state the best reply/residual.

Coverage mapping: C14 — Criticisms and replies.

PYQ linkage: Evaluation across 2021, 2022, 2023 and 2025.

MCQ 50

Which practice is safest in a UPSC answer on Hegel?

- A. treat the Phenomenology, Logic, and philosophy of history as versions of one identical three-stage sequence with interchangeable terms
- B. quote thesis-antithesis-synthesis as Hegel's universal formula without a provenance caution
- C. identify the register, paraphrase safely, and anchor translation-sensitive claims to sections
- D. attribute later Marxist and anti-colonial uses of recognition directly to Hegel's own text

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: Logical categories, shapes of consciousness and historical institutions are distinct explanatory registers. - **B:** Incorrect: The formula is later shorthand associated with Fichte and Chalybaeus, not Hegel's universal wording. - **C:** Correct: Register and source discipline prevent false quotations and category mistakes across Hegel's works. - **D:** Incorrect: Later receptions transform Hegelian themes and must be identified as receptions rather than original doctrine.

Examiner trap 50: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Sources, registers, quotation and scope discipline.**

Repair action: Distinguish logical, phenomenological and historical registers; use safe quotations and owner boundaries.

Coverage mapping: C15 — Sources, registers, quotation and scope discipline.

PYQ linkage: All answers; prevents provenance and scope errors.

MCQ 51

Which plan most directly answers the verified 2026 Hegel question?

- A. define the Absolute as static being and substitute a detailed chronological survey of Hegel's major philosophical works
- B. contrast static being with self-developing result, trace Becoming, and map Logic-Nature-Spirit
- C. explain only political history through the one-some-all account of developing freedom
- D. reconstruct Berkeley's ideas and divine perception before briefly mentioning Absolute Idealism

Answer: B.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The prompt asks why Absolute being is becoming, so biography and a static definition miss its demand. - **B:** Correct: This plan joins the opening logical transition to the Absolute's systemic self-development and adds needed qualification. - **C:** Incorrect: History is one application of development but does not explain the exact being-becoming identity. - **D:** Incorrect: Berkeley is not the question's subject and would displace Hegel's logical and systematic argument.

Examiner trap 51: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Direct PYQ ownership and transfer.**

Repair action: Recognise the seven direct parts, four bounded cross-links and exact 2026 demand.

Coverage mapping: C16 — Direct PYQ ownership and transfer.

PYQ linkage: All seven direct PYQs through 2026.

MCQ 52

Which statement correctly describes Hegel PYQ ownership in the verified 2018–2026 Western Philosophy record?

- A. Hegel owns six parts because the 2026 supplement does not change earlier topic packages
- B. Hegel owns every question naming him, including all four comparison questions routed elsewhere
- C. Hegel owns seven parts; 2018 and 2024 have none, and four comparisons remain cross-links
- D. Hegel owns eight parts because the 2026 Kant comparison must be counted under both owners

Answer: C.

Option explanations: - **A:** Incorrect: The repository-controlled 2026 supplement adds Q1(c) as a directly owned Hegel part. - **B:** Incorrect: Mention and comparison do not establish primary ownership; the four bounded questions remain with their routed owners. - **C:** Correct: Single-owner routing yields seven direct parts and preserves four comparison links without double counting. - **D:** Incorrect: The 2026 Q4(b) comparison remains Kant-owned, so counting it again under Hegel would inflate coverage.

Examiner trap 52: Choosing by a familiar slogan while missing the cell's controlling distinction: **Direct PYQ ownership and transfer.**

Repair action: Recognise the seven direct parts, four bounded cross-links and exact 2026 demand.

Coverage mapping: C16 — Direct PYQ ownership and transfer.

PYQ linkage: All seven direct PYQs through 2026.